

# Abhinav Kaushik

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Hiring Team

Bolt

## Re: Senior Data Scientist – Ranking and Recommendations, Bolt Food

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the ranking and recommendations role on Bolt Food. Re-ranking is the thread through my work: I shipped a re-ranker into a live plan-recommendation system that had to serve customer relevance and renewal targets at the same time, and more recently fine-tuned a cross-encoder over a dense retrieval stage. The home screen problem you describe, deciding what a customer sees and in what order, is the version of this I want to work on next.

My fiancée lives in Berlin and that is where we are making our home, so I am building my career in the city where my life already is. On the substance of how you work I need no convincing: sitting next to the operations and engineering teams whose decisions the models automate is how I have always worked best, and at Viavi the POCs that survived were the ones where I was in the room with the people who owned the outcome.

Two things I would bring. First, I have taken models the whole way: an SLA-breach prediction system on LightGBM, FastAPI and MLflow that cut downtime by 67%, and forecasting and anomaly detection across 500+ devices monitored in production. Second, I build the evaluation before the model. The offline evaluation and observability pipelines I designed for our agents cut human review by 43%, and that habit is what stops a ranking change from shipping on a hunch.

Outside work I am building ThinkTree.AI, a non-profit AI learning platform used by NGO teachers to support students with ADHD. Watching real users ignore features I was sure about has done more for my product sense than any metric dashboard. I would welcome a conversation about the role.

Sincerely,

Abhinav Kaushik